TechDea LMS - UI / UX Audit

A plain-English list of UI problems found across the web app (desktop and mobile), with a short description and a suggested fix for each. Priority key: **Critical** = broken / unusable, **High** = clearly hurts users, **Medium** = polish and consistency, **Low** = minor.

76 issues Critical: 4 | High: 10 | Medium: 39 | Low: 23

1. Mobile & responsive design

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**No lesson list on phones**	In the lesson player the whole module/lesson menu is hidden on screens under 900px. Learners can only go one lesson forward or back and cannot see progress or jump around.	Show the lesson list as a slide-in drawer on mobile, opened by a 'Lessons' button in the top bar.	Critical
2	**Lesson buttons don't fit on phones**	The 'Previous', 'Mark as Complete' and 'Next' buttons sit in one row with no mobile rule, so they squash and wrap badly on small screens.	On small screens stack a full-width 'Mark as Complete' on top, with Previous/Next side by side below.	Critical
3	**Tables break on mobile**	A CSS rule turns the <table> itself into a block on small screens, which breaks the table layout. Two tables (Admin Users, Course Enrollments) also have no scroll box, so they push the page sideways.	Remove that rule and wrap every table in a horizontal scroll container; use stacked cards for the widest tables.	Critical
4	**Course page 'Enroll' button hidden on mobile**	On the course details page the price/enroll box drops to the very bottom on phones, under the full description, curriculum and all reviews.	Reorder so the enroll box shows first on mobile, or add a small sticky enroll bar at the bottom.	Critical
5	**Course cards too cramped on small laptops**	The 3-column card grid stays 3-wide until 900px, then jumps straight to 1. Between about 900-1100px each card is only ~180px wide and looks squashed.	Add a 2-column step for medium widths (max-width 1100px).	High
6	**Stat cards stay 3-wide on phones**	Some pages force a 3-column stat row with an inline style, which overrides the mobile rule that should drop it to 2. On a phone the three number cards get crushed.	Move the 3-column choice into a CSS class so the mobile rule can still apply.	Medium
7	**Sign-up card can be cut off**	The sign-up form is centered vertically. On short screens (landscape phone) a tall form overflows and the top of the card cannot be scrolled to.	Align the auth card to the top and add spacing, or let the panel scroll.	Medium
8	**Sticky enroll box slides under the top bar**	The enroll box sticks 16px from the top, but the page's translucent top bar is ~58px tall, so the box tucks partly behind it.	Set the sticky offset to about 74px (top bar height plus a gap).	Medium
9	**Close (X) lands in the wrong place**	When the lesson player header wraps on medium screens, the close X moves to the middle of a second row instead of staying top-right.	Pin the close button to the top-right and hide the 'Lesson X of Y' text on small screens.	Medium

2. Layout, spacing & alignment

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**Card buttons don't line up**	On the Browse Courses page cards in a row have different heights because some show a rating or level tag and some don't, so the 'Enroll' buttons sit at different heights.	Add a flexible spacer so the button always sticks to the bottom of the card.	Medium
2	**Many hand-tweaked card paddings**	List cards use inline padding of '10px 12px' in about 15 places and '12px 14px' in others, instead of one shared style. Spacing feels slightly different from list to list.	Create a '.card--compact' style and use it everywhere instead of inline padding.	Medium

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
3	**Module info not aligned on course page**	On the course details page the lesson count sits jammed next to the module name instead of at the right edge like it does in the editor.	Push the count to the right with margin-left:auto in the shared style.	Low
4	**Blank gaps where lesson time should be**	Lessons with no set duration render an empty space, so a mix of timed and untimed lessons has a ragged edge.	Show nothing on purpose, or a consistent dash.	Low

3. Text, sizes & headings

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**Page titles are different sizes**	Most pages use a large heading, but Profile and Progress use a much smaller one, so those page titles look like small sub-headings.	Use one shared page-title style on every page.	High
2	**Error pages use a smaller heading**	'Page not found' and 'Course not found' use a smaller heading than normal pages.	Give error screens the same title size as normal pages.	Medium
3	**No real text scale**	Font sizes like 13, 13.5, 14 and 12 are typed straight into the code in dozens of places. Small text next to slightly different small text looks misaligned.	Define a few text-size tokens and reuse them instead of inline sizes.	Medium
4	**Heading levels skip**	Some pages jump from a level-2 heading to a level-4 heading with nothing between, which makes the structure inconsistent for screen readers.	Use heading levels in order: page title, then section, then sub-section.	Low

4. Colours & contrast

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**Tiny grey text is too faint**	Labels like lesson duration (10px), table headers, kickers and timestamps use light grey at very small sizes. They fail accessibility contrast rules and are hard to read.	Darken the muted grey, never use the lightest grey for text, and set a minimum readable size.	High
2	**Delete buttons turn purple on hover**	Red 'Delete' / 'Leave' / 'Remove' buttons are styled inline. On hover they pick up the app's purple tint, which is the wrong signal for a destructive action.	Add a proper danger button style with a red-tinted hover.	Medium
3	**Dropdowns look like Windows, not the app**	Native <select> menus keep the operating-system arrow and chrome, so they clash with the custom-styled inputs next to them.	Style the dropdown with a custom arrow and matching height.	Medium
4	**Three dropdown sizes, three tab styles, two checkbox styles**	The same actions are built differently on different pages: filters are sometimes pill tabs, sometimes plain buttons, sometimes a dropdown; one editor uses a round radio for a checkbox.	Pick one component for each job (one tab style, one dropdown size, square checkbox vs round radio) and use it everywhere.	Medium
5	**'Enroll' vs 'Enrol' on the same page**	Buttons use the US spelling 'Enroll' while body text uses the UK spelling 'enrol', sometimes both on one screen.	Pick one spelling and use it everywhere.	Medium
6	**Button text casing is mixed**	Some buttons are Title Case ('Save Changes', 'New Course') and others are sentence case ('Post review', 'Add item'), sometimes in the same view.	Choose sentence case for all buttons and apply it consistently.	Medium
7	**One tag style means three things**	The outline tag is used for a neutral status, a warning ('Stalled') and an inactive flag ('Off'). An amber tag style exists but is never used.	Map each status to its own colour/meaning and use the amber tag for warnings.	Low

5. Buttons, forms & controls

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**Form labels aren't linked to fields**	Almost every form has a label that is not tied to its input. Clicking the label doesn't focus the field, and screen readers can't name the field.	Wrap each input in its label, or link them with matching id / htmlFor.	**High**
2	**Pop-ups don't trap keyboard focus**	When a modal opens, keyboard focus stays on the page behind it, and pressing Tab moves through the hidden page. Focus is not returned to where it was on close.	Move focus into the modal on open, keep Tab inside it, and restore focus on close.	**High**
3	**Quiz options show no keyboard focus**	Quiz answer choices hide the real radio button and never show a focus outline, so a keyboard user taking a timed quiz can't tell which option is selected.	Add a visible focus outline to the option when its input is focused.	**High**
4	**Clickable table rows can't be used by keyboard**	The Students table opens a details pop-up when a row is clicked, but rows have no keyboard support at all, so the whole table is mouse-only.	Make the row's name a real link/button, or add keyboard role and Enter/Space handling.	**High**
5	**Sticky bits inside pop-ups stick to the wrong place**	The quiz timer bar is meant to stay pinned at the top of a scrolling modal, but the modal body isn't the scroll area, so the timer scrolls partly off before it pins.	Make the modal body the scroll area with a fixed header, then sticky children work.	**Medium**
6	**Long quiz builder has no fixed Save bar**	With many questions, the Cancel/Save buttons sit far below the fold and the 'Published' checkbox is right at the bottom.	Keep the modal footer with Save/Cancel pinned to the bottom.	**Medium**
7	**Quiz 'correct answer' toggle is unclear**	Each answer option has a grey pill that says 'correct'. It reads like a label, not a control, so it's hard to see which option is the right answer.	Use one clear 'Correct answer' choice per question with a strong selected state.	**Medium**
8	**Thumbnail upload can't be used by keyboard**	The 'Upload image' button is a label around a hidden file input, and neither can be reached by keyboard.	Use a real button that opens the file picker, with a visible focus style.	**Medium**
9	**Filter pills only work in modern browsers**	The selected state of the pill tab control relies on the CSS :has() feature with no fallback. In older browsers no tab looks selected.	Also add a plain 'active' class with JavaScript as a fallback.	**Medium**
10	**Dead bell icon and leftover search styles**	The bell in the top bar does nothing when clicked. CSS for a search box that was removed is still in the stylesheet.	Either build a simple notifications menu or remove the bell; delete the unused search CSS.	**Medium**
11	**Account actions are split up**	'Sign out' is at the bottom of the side menu, but 'Profile' is only the small avatar in the top-right corner. The user card in the sidebar looks clickable but isn't.	Put Profile and Sign out together, and make the sidebar user card a real menu.	**Medium**
12	**Mobile menu has weak behaviour**	The slide-in menu on mobile can't be closed with Escape, doesn't stop the page behind it from scrolling, and doesn't return focus to the menu button.	Add Escape-to-close, lock background scroll, and trap/restore focus (the modal already does this).	**Medium**
13	**Browser confirm box for deletes**	Every 'are you sure?' uses the plain grey browser popup, even though the app has its own nice modal and toast style.	Build one shared confirm dialog using the app's modal.	**Medium**
14	**'Leave course' as loud as 'Continue'**	Every course card in My Learning shows a red 'Leave course' button right under the main Continue button.	Move it into a small menu or make it a quiet link.	**Medium**
15	**'Enrolled' state is a dead end**	On Browse Courses, after you enroll the button becomes a disabled 'Enrolled' with no way to start the course.	Change it to an active 'Go to course' link.	**Medium**
16	**Fake tab roles for screen readers**	The status filter is marked as a 'tablist' for screen readers but has none of the needed tab wiring, so it announces as broken.	Either wire up proper tabs or remove the tablist role.	**Low**
17	**Modal title is very small**	A wide 880px pop-up still uses a 16px title, and a long title can wrap under the close X.	Use a bigger modal title and leave room for the close button.	**Low**
18	**Some action columns have no header name**	A few tables have an empty header cell with no hidden label for screen readers (other tables do this correctly).	Add a hidden label to every column header.	**Low**

6. Overflow & things getting cut off

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**Long links in lesson text cause sideways scroll**	Lesson reading text keeps line breaks but does not break long words or URLs, so a long link pushes the content sideways.	Allow long words to wrap (overflow-wrap: anywhere).	**Medium**
2	**Long lesson titles widen the course page**	On the course details page a very long unbroken lesson title can stretch its column and make the whole page scroll sideways.	Let title text shrink and wrap inside its column.	**Medium**
3	**Wide staff tables scroll the page**	Admin Users and Course Enrollments tables have no scroll box, and the action button groups never shrink, so on smaller laptops the page scrolls sideways.	Wrap all tables in a scroll box; collapse the 4-button action group into a menu on narrow screens.	**High**
4	**Light scrollbar on the dark sidebar**	When the side menu has many items, it shows a bright default scrollbar against the near-black background.	Style the sidebar scrollbar to be thin and dark.	**Low**
5	**Big spinner inside small pop-ups**	The loading spinner reserves 55% of the screen height, so inside a small modal it makes the modal very tall, then it snaps small when content loads.	Use a small loader sized for modals.	**Low**

7. Consistency across pages

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**Empty states look very different**	Some empty screens show a nice card with an icon, message and button; others show just one line of grey text that looks unfinished.	Make one shared empty-state component and use it everywhere.	**Medium**
2	**Three ways of showing 'loading', and unused skeletons**	Loading shows as a big spinner, a full-screen spinner, or plain 'Loading...' text. Nice shimmer 'skeleton' styles are written in CSS but never used.	Use skeleton placeholders for lists and tables; keep the spinner for buttons and full-page waits.	**Medium**
3	**Three screens show the same progress data**	The Dashboard, My Learning and Progress pages all show enrolled courses and percent complete in different layouts. Progress adds nothing new and looks the least finished.	Merge Progress into My Learning, or give it a clear separate purpose.	**Medium**
4	**Two different 'list of students' screens**	One students page has search, filter, CSV export and a details pop-up; the other has none of these and a different table style.	Share one students-table component for both.	**Medium**
5	**Stat numbers are different sizes per page**	Stat card numbers are 25px on some pages and 22px on others because two CSS rules disagree.	Pick one stat number size and delete the other rule.	**Medium**
6	**Middle-dot separators wrap badly**	Lists join items with a middle dot. Sometimes the dot ends up alone at the start of a new line.	Use spacing (flex gap) instead of dot characters, or a dot that can't be orphaned.	**Low**
7	**Reading width changes between pages**	Lesson text is limited to 68 characters wide in one place, 80 in another, and unlimited in the preview.	Use one comfortable reading width everywhere text appears.	**Low**
8	**'Jump to' cards repeat the side menu**	The teacher dashboard has three cards that just link to pages already in the sidebar.	Replace them with something useful (ungraded work, recent sign-ups) or remove them.	**Low**

8. Loading, empty & error states

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**Failed loads look like 'no data'**	If a request fails, most pages just show the empty state. A failed dashboard says 'enrol in your first course' even to a student with courses, with no retry.	Tell loading, truly-empty and error apart; show an error message with a Retry button.	**High**

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
2	**Toasts don't tell success from failure**	The same dark pill shows for 'Saved' and for 'Network Error'. There's no colour, no icon, no way to re-read it, and screen readers don't hear it. It disappears after 2.6s.	Add success/error styles and icons, announce it to screen readers, pause on hover, and add a close button.	High
3	**Timed quiz gives no spoken warnings**	The quiz timer only turns red in the last 30 seconds and then auto-submits. Screen-reader users get no warning, and there's no check before submitting with unanswered questions.	Announce time left at 5 min, 1 min and 30 sec; confirm before submitting an incomplete quiz.	Medium
4	**Reviews section shows plain 'Loading reviews...' text**	The course page loads the main content with a spinner but the reviews block just shows a line of text.	Use a small skeleton for the reviews block.	Low
5	**Embedded files show a blank white box while loading**	Word, PowerPoint and Drive previews show an empty white area for several seconds with no spinner.	Show a spinner over the frame until it finishes loading.	Low
6	**Progress bars re-animate on every update**	Every time a list re-renders, all the progress bars replay their grow animation from zero.	Play the grow animation only once when the bar first appears.	Low
7	**Startup screen looks empty and says the wrong thing**	Refreshing the login page briefly shows a full-screen 'Loading your learning hub...' with lots of empty space and no logo.	Use neutral 'Loading...' text and show the logo above the spinner.	Low
8	**Lesson-player error screens have no navigation**	'Not enrolled' and 'Course not found' inside the lesson player show a narrow column with no sidebar or header.	Show these inside the normal app layout with a working back link.	Medium
9	**Two side buttons look the same weight**	In table rows, 'secondary' and 'ghost' buttons look almost identical, so four row actions of similar importance have no clear order.	Keep one clear button for the main action; move the rest into a menu.	Medium

9. Accessibility (keyboard & screen readers)

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**Show/hide password can't be reached by keyboard**	The eye icon that reveals the password is set to be skipped by the Tab key.	Let the Tab key reach it; it already has a proper label.	Medium
2	**Reduced-motion setting is only half honoured**	Users who ask for less motion still get buttons that lift on hover, cards that slide, and smooth-scroll jumps.	Also turn off hover movement and smooth scrolling when reduced motion is requested.	Medium
3	**Progress bars have no label for screen readers**	The bars are just coloured divs with no role or value, so screen readers say nothing.	Add a progressbar role with the value and a label.	Low
4	**Teacher answers lose their line breaks**	A teacher's multi-line answer to a doubt shows as one run-on paragraph to the student.	Keep line breaks when showing the answer.	Low

10. Polish & extras

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
1	**No site icon or page description**	The browser tab shows a blank globe icon. There's no description, theme colour, or social-share preview.	Add a favicon (the graduation-cap mark), a page description, and basic social tags.	Medium
2	**Fonts load in a slow way**	The Inter font is pulled in with a CSS @import, which delays styling and causes a visible text jump on first load.	Load the font with <link> tags in the page head, or host it with the app.	Medium

#	Problem	Description	Solution	Priority
3	**Course images crop differently everywhere**	The thumbnail has no fixed shape, so the same course picture is cropped to a different ratio on each screen. The 'no image' fallback is one tiny icon in a big box.	Give thumbnails a fixed aspect ratio; make the fallback fill the space better.	**Medium**
4	**Course images are stored inside the data**	Uploaded images are saved as long text (base64) inside the course record, so course lists download slowly.	Upload images to file storage and save just a link.	**Low**
5	**Number fields don't limit values**	Fields like pass mark accept out-of-range numbers (e.g. 150%) on the screen, and show the plain browser up/down arrows.	Clamp values as they're typed and style the number fields.	**Low**
6	**'Free' price block looks like leftover shop design**	The course page shows a big bold 'Free' like a price, and 'Free' also appears as a tag and in the button text.	Show a small 'Free - lifetime access' line instead of a price-sized element.	**Low**
7	**Text promises locking that doesn't exist**	Lesson text says 'mark complete to unlock the next one', but every lesson is already open and nothing is locked.	Either add real step-by-step unlocking or change the wording.	**Low**
8	**No warning about unsaved changes**	Leaving the course editor or profile form mid-edit throws away your changes with no warning (only the lesson notes box warns).	Add a shared 'you have unsaved changes' guard to the edit forms.	**Low**

Biggest single win: most 'Medium' consistency issues come from inline styles overriding the design system. Pulling a few shared pieces (compact card, danger button, page title, one dropdown, one empty-state, one loader, one error box) and removing the matching inline styles would clear about a third of this list at once.